The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Liberating from the Eight Great Fears"

Āryāṣṭamahābhayatāraṇīnāmadhāraṇī · Toh 931 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་འཇིགས་པ་ཆེན་པོ་བོར་བ་སྒྲུབ་ལས་གཞོལ་པ་ཞེས་བྱ་འགྲེངས།

The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Liberating from the Eight Great Fears," known in Sanskrit as the Āryāṣṭamahābhayatāraṇīnāmadhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Phakpa Jikpa Chenpo Gyé Lé Drolwa Zhejawé Zung, is a short ritual text centered on a protective incantation meant to free those who recite it from the eight great fears. It opens with homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas and then to a series of tathāgatas, among them Guṇākara, Samantagandha, Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin, and King of Peace, followed by homage to a bodhisattva great being endowed with great compassion who grants fearlessness. The core of the text is the dhāraṇī itself, a string of sacred syllables, after which the speaker addresses a child of noble family about the secret words that have just been revealed. This work is Toh 931 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the class of dhāraṇī texts, the collection of incantations prized in the Tibetan tradition for their protective and beneficial power.

In the language of India: āryāṣṭa mahābhaya tāraṇī nāma dhāraṇī
In the language of Tibet: The Noble Dhāraṇī Called "Liberating from the Eight Great Fears."

Homage to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas!
Homage to the Tathāgata Guṇākara!
Homage to the Tathāgata Samantagandha!
Homage to the Tathāgata Endowed with Prowess Unconquerable by Others!
Homage to the Tathāgata Sarvanīvaraṇaviṣkambhin!
Homage to the Tathāgata Supreme Moon!
Homage to the Tathāgata King of Peace!
Homage to the Tathāgata Highest of Moons!
Homage to the bodhisattva great being who is endowed with great compassion and who grants fearlessness!

tadyathā dhare dhare dhāre dhāraṇī ratnakoṭe abhayakalbe kalbeni gaṇe anantakalbe amṛtakalbe hutāśare anantamukhe anantacakṣu samutgate oṃ bha svāhā

Child of noble family, these secret mantras of the dhāraṇī have been spoken, blessed, and rejoiced in by buddhas, blessed ones as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges, for the benefit of sentient beings who are going to the lower realms.

Child of noble family, any bodhisattva who holds this dhāraṇī will pass completely beyond the eight fears: the boundless fear of the hells, the boundless fear of birth as an animal, the boundless fear of the world of Yama, the boundless fear of the hungry ghosts, the boundless fear of places hard to cross, the boundless fear of birth, the boundless fear of sickness, and the boundless fear of death.

The buddhas, the blessed ones of the ten directions, will keep that person in mind. At the time of death, that person will die with a mind free of distraction and will be born in the presence of the buddhas. That person will obtain an inexhaustible body, and will also obtain an emanation body.

namaḥ sarva bidyā siddhyantu me mantrapāda svāhā

Here ends the noble dhāraṇī called "Liberating from the Eight Great Fears."

Translator's Notes

• Four tathāgata names could not be matched to Sanskrit forms with confidence, so their meanings are given in English. They are "Endowed with Prowess Unconquerable by Others" (possibly Aparājitavikrama), "Supreme Moon" (possibly Candrottama), "King of Peace," and "Highest of Moons" (possibly Candrottara). The bodhisattva in the final homage is described but not named. "Places hard to cross" renders bgrod dka' ba, meaning perilous passages or wildernesses. The Tibetan title line reads sgrol pa, while the colophon reads sgrol ba; both are rendered the same way.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly

proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.